



“A content management system (CMS) such as a document management system (DMS) is a computer application used to manage workflow needed to collaboratively create, edit, review, index, search, publish and archive various kinds of digital media and electronic text.”

Okay, that actually made the concept seem a little more confusing, didn't it? In layman terms, a CMS is a software that helps you to publish and manage content online, in a much easier and more efficient way. Traditionally, it used to take considerable knowledge and experience in HTML, PHP (server-side programming languages) and JavaScript to be able to churn out a 'professional-looking' website. A CMS is designed to make your life easier

as a Web master, and encourages you to spend more time with the content, because, 'Content is the King'.

In favour of a CMS—Why?

- **Content modelling and storage:** This is the process by which you take the content you want to manage, and turn it into data that the system can process and store. A mature CMS makes it absolutely easy for the Web master to create the flow of the content, and even facilitates easy storage and retrieval of the data. Compare a CMS with cup noodles. It's all ready—all you need to do is pour some water and leave it aside for a minute or so.
- **Content editing:** In my brief Web developing career, there have been times when the choice of CMS was decided by the kind of text editor it offers. Well, while you'd always feel compelled to rubbish that line of thought, as a Web master, it *does* make a lot of sense at the end of the day. Ideally, the job of a Web master is the management of a website and not content population. Now, unless the person assigned to populate the site is well-versed with HTML tags and style sheets, the ease of use and the power of the editor become important factors to be considered. Of course, most modern-day editors allow you to edit the raw HTML of your content, in the same window, thus giving you more power and flexibility.

Here, I'd like to mention a thought that just crossed my mind. I remember, while designing a website for one of our sister concerns, *itmagz.com* (it's on Joomla!), the content editor was very basic and needed me to set up my HTML editor from the site's preference menu. It used to freak me out every time, until I decided to go ahead and install JCE as the new editor.

- **Publishing and templating:** One of the most important focus points every time you get on to developing a new website is a 'spanking new' look and feel. It is a well-known

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